the actions of the previous day. The delegation also encouraged the leadership at the monastery to stop further protests from occurring. The tension actually escalated as protesters gathered outside burning the cars of government officials. The 1,000-strong crowd demanded detained protesters from the previous day be released. Eventually the officials escaped after a nearly six-hour standoff. State-controlled media denounced the monks' action and they were blamed for the outbreak of hostilities. Warnings were issued that any further protest attempts would not be tolerated. A reference was made that a repeat of the events of 1988 would not occur.

The Pakokku incident led to the formation of the All Burma Monks Alliance (ABMA). A statement was issued by the new organization on September 9, giving the State Peace and Development Council (SPDC) a week to comply with several demands or face a religious boycott.

New forces were emerging to oppose the regime by 2007. Social activists concerned with economic and social problems rather than the traditional and older pro-democracy movements were appearing. Furthermore, many of the 88-generation student activists had been released from prison and started to reform old network connections by the time of the 2007 price hike. Within the first week following the price increase, over 100 demonstrators were arrested. The government goal was a broader crackdown as residences were searched and documents seized. At times, the junta used militias hired by the USDA. International media outlets began to cover the events, which initially were not that substantial.

The newly formed ABMA issued a challenge to the regime. First, the authorities were to apologize for the Pakokku fiasco. Second, all political prisoners, including Aung San Suu Kyi, were to be released. Third, fuel and commodity prices had to be reduced. Finally, a dialogue was to be opened to promote national reconciliation. The deadline was to coincide with the anniversary of the brutal crackdown by State Law and Order Restoration Council in 1988.

The regime attempted to divide the protest movement. Attempts to buy off the loyalty of monasteries with financial gifts were made, but by and large failed. The crackdown continued and the public relations campaign accelerated as the SPDC attempted to vilify the movement. The state-run